2025 → 2026 · a developer's look

Do LinkedIn influencers type every reply by hand?

I wanted to automate my own inbox. So I checked what LinkedIn **allows**, and what it **did** to tools that went further.

Short answer: the API lets you **post**. Sending **DMs** is for approved partners only. Tools that do more work in a grey zone, and LinkedIn is closing it.

ALLOWED the official rules

What the API really gives you

yes	Post, comment, react for a member (`w_member_social`)
partners	Messaging API. 1st-degree only. No automated or scheduled sends.
no	A delegate role for a personal profile. Only Company Pages have admins.
no	Sharing your account. The User Agreement forbids it.
EU only	Read your **own** inbox through the DMA portability API. Read-only.

COURT 2025-01-24 → 2025-07-04

LinkedIn sues Proxycurl. Five months later it is gone.

$10M

The founder's own words: a "~$10M revenue business", shut down to comply with the settlement.

- Claim: **hundreds of thousands** of fake accounts scraped millions of profiles.
- Permanent injunction: delete all the data, stop all access.

PAGE REMOVED 2025-03-07

Apollo.io and Seamless.AI lose their company pages

No public reason. The tools kept working. Apollo's page is back by mid-2026.

> "does not disrupt Apollo's services or impact our core platform functionality"
>
> Apollo, March 2025

The lesson: LinkedIn does not only block bots. It hits the **brand** of the vendor, where reach lives.

COURT 2025-10

ProAPIs: scraping as a subscription

$15k/month

What customers reportedly paid for scraped LinkedIn data.

- Claim: **millions** of fake accounts.
- "Hundreds if not thousands" of new fake accounts **per day**.
- LinkedIn says it detects the scraping **within hours**, but cannot stop all of it.

DETECTION July–December 2025

Fake accounts rarely reach your report button

99.7%

of fake accounts were stopped **before** any member reported them.

- **97.8%** of them were blocked by automated defenses.
- **98.6%** of removed spam and scams were caught automatically.

PAGE REMOVED 2026-03-25

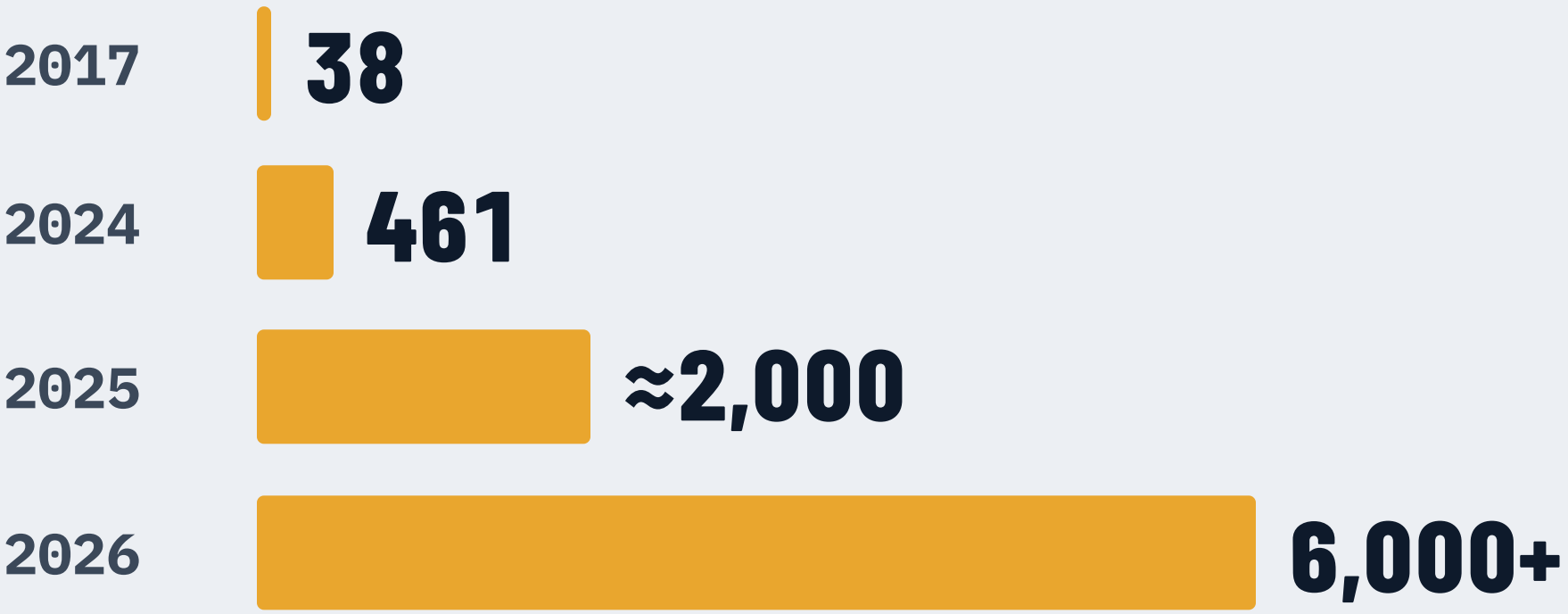
HeyReach: the page and four executives

- Company page removed, about **16,400 followers**.
- CEO, CTO, CRO and CMO profiles restricted (HeyReach says: temporarily).
- Customer campaigns kept running.
- No reason published by LinkedIn.

HeyReach runs LinkedIn accounts from the **cloud**. Rivals say that is why. Nobody has proof.

DETECTION 2026-04 · "BrowserGate"

LinkedIn checks your browser for 6,000+ extensions



- A 2.7 MB script also reads CPU cores, memory, screen, timezone, battery.
- LinkedIn: it looks for extensions that **scrape or break the terms**.

Marcel Petrick · 8/9 · extension IDs probed →

so, the teams of influencers?

Their options: shared logins, cloud tools, extensions. All grey.

- The "40% of automation users banned" figure traces back to **one** unverified source.
- LinkedIn publishes no ban rate. Vendors on both sides call the other side unsafe.

My route: a local tool **reads and drafts**. I still **send** every reply myself.

Sources · LinkedIn help a1341387 · LinkedIn Community Report H2 2025 · Bloomberg Law 2025-10-29 · The Record · Social Media Today (Proxycurl) · nubela.co "Goodbye Proxycurl" · Salesmotion (Apollo) · heyreach.io/blog/heyreach-ban · gHacks / Tom's Hardware (BrowserGate) · leadsforlinked fact-check. Full list with links in the comments.

facts as of 2026-10-27